

Microsoft versus Linux

The argument can go on and on. Reliability maybe Linux's forte while usability is Windows' domain. Here are two expert views on the matter

'Microsoft fits perfectly...'

S B Patankar

CTO, The Bombay Stock Exchange, Dalal Street

Traditionally, our office has been running Windows. We tested Linux on an experimental basis. But, Microsoft fits perfectly with our needs. Our office at BSE houses 500 computers, for as many people. Here, user-friendliness and ease of operation are big issues—Microsoft takes care of both.

We have a tie-up with Microsoft, and it comes with a full suite of products and applications, which make operations much easier. As a result of this tie-up, Microsoft also takes special care of our organisation with facilities such as patch management. Networking is another major factor. Given the work we do, we cannot afford too many disruptions. Microsoft has fared well in this regard.

Although open source operating systems are freely available, at low costs, we will continue with Microsoft, its disruption quotient being negligible. Though we can, we won't switch operating systems, since productivity and efficiency are more important, not just the cost factor. As we are totally used to working with Microsoft, changing from one platform to another will be a laborious migration.

As told to Syed Nadim Siraj



'We have an assurance...'

Sanjay Sharma

Head, Information Technology, IDBI Bank

At IDBI Bank, we have been running Linux since June 2002. We have more than 1,600 employees across over 100 offices. We consider technical issues and hardware resource requirements from the perspective of server-sizing. We also consider on-going maintenance cost such as Annual Technical Support (ATS), Total Cost of Ownership (TCO), etc. Based on detailed analysis of these parameters, we select the OS for each application.

Linux fit the bill. Windows is easier to administer, but it's unstable and expensive. Linux is stable and scalable. Our overall productivity has definitely gone up. We achieved substantial savings on hardware, OS and license cost. We purchased Intel boxes, which could scale up to our requirements as the volume grew, without any hardware upgrades. It was definitely a case of much lower TCO for the bank. For system administrators, we did a small review course.

We have an assurance from Red Hat (Clover Technologies) for support for our deployment too. You shouldn't buy a product or OS, based on who the vendor is!

As told to Suprotip Ghosh

